

Dr. Art E. Fact

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Ask Reed what he has discovered in the accession records.
3. Determine whether Claire commissioned outside provenance research.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to expose an error in my best-known article. I would have preferred a discreet correction. He preferred a microphone and an audience.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Media Room archive scanner from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Media Room archive scanner. I was dealing with correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Media Room archive scanner throughout the whole window. It also exposes correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Media Room archive scanner. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.